

iQOO working on interesting smartphone innovations for 2023, says India CEO Nipun Marya

We recently spoke with iQOO's India CEO, Mr Nipun Marya about the brand's future strategy in India, and more...

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iQOO started 2023 with its flagship, the iQOO 11, which was the first smartphone in the country to come with the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 chipset. After that, in February the company brought its mid-ranger, the iQOO Neo 7, making it the first smartphone to come with a MediaTek Dimensity 8200 SoC in India. Now, we are in March and iQOO has launched its latest sub-Rs 20,000 offering, the iQOO Z7 5G, which, as you guessed, is the first smartphone in India to come with the MediaTek Dimensity 920 SoC.

While the brand is setting trends in 2023 without anyone noticing, there is still a long way to go for iQOO, which has established itself as a young, enthusiastic and power-focused brand. However, there is still a way to go for the brand in terms of mass appeal. iQOO, while launching brilliant products like the iQOO Neo 7 or the iQOO 11 of this year, also struggles to get out of its sister brand Vivo's shadow, at least in India.

This year, I have reviewed all three smartphones that the brand has launched in India (iQOO 11, iQOO Neo 7 and iQOO Z7 5G) and I had very little to nothing to criticise these smartphones for. However, despite releasing some of the best smartphones out there, iQOO still struggles to create a top-of-the-mind recall when it comes to people looking for smartphones on a certain budget. Many



Nipun Marya
CEO, iQOO

a time, people outside of the tech space have asked me what company this is, or if these smartphones are any good. So, we got hold of iQOO India's CEO Nipun Marya, who gave us a better idea about the brand's approach towards the Indian market, its efforts to increase awareness, and what we can expect from iQOO in the future. Let's take a look:

Vision For India - "Immense Opportunity Amid Digital Transformation"

We asked Marya about iQOO's vision for India, to which the iQOO India

CEO said that the Indian market has grown steadily over the past five years, except for the COVID period. "This year (2023), the market is expected to increase by 10 per cent to 175 million units. While the urban markets are growing, we see immense opportunity from the rural/Tier 2-3 markets as well. With higher internet adoption, more and more consumers getting 'smarter', digital transformation within the country and 5G connectivity, there is also a rising demand for smartphones to do much more."

Marya also said that iQOO has already carved a space for iQOO as a brand with a power-packed portfolio of products that offers industry-best performance, enabling the smartphones to do all that the customer wants. "At iQOO, our strong belief is to offer the best performance with consistent innovation in a powerful package that helps us offer performance that pushes the limits of technology, the power that redefines the limits of minds and innovation that transforms the meaning of new," he said.

On iQOO Becoming Mainstream - "Focus on Performance & Innovation"

On iQOO's image as a brand that brings gaming-centric devices in each segment, Marya said that the company has seen steady growth and an encouraging response across price points, given our focus on performance-oriented products. "We will continue to focus towards innovating performance-driven products across segments. We have already expanded our portfolio